`HasColumnName` method when configuring the `CountryCode` property.

## 8.2 Migrations

You are almost at the point where you can create a migration that keeps the database schema in sync with the model. The migration tooling examines the `DbSet` properties of the context and compares them to a snapshot generated by the previous migration if there was one. Any differences result in C# code being generated, which, when executed, is translated into SQL that applies changes to the actual database. The first migration will result in the database being created if it doesn't already exist. It is also possible to generate the migration SQL scripts on demand, so you can apply them to the database yourself. This is particularly useful for making the changes to your live database, where it is often difficult, if not impossible, to execute C# code.

One other aspect of configuration that can be very useful is the capability to specify seed data, which is used to populate the database during a migration. This feature has obvious uses in that it can get you started with a set of data without manually entering it. In the next section, you will look at using this feature with some country data, followed by some city data.

The migration download that comes with this chapter (http://mng.bz/jAra) also includes seed data for the `Property` type as well as some images (courtesy of https://unsplash.com/) for cities. I recommend you obtain the relevant code and images from the GitHub repo and use that for your migration, so your database content matches the examples going forward.

### 8.2.1 Seed data